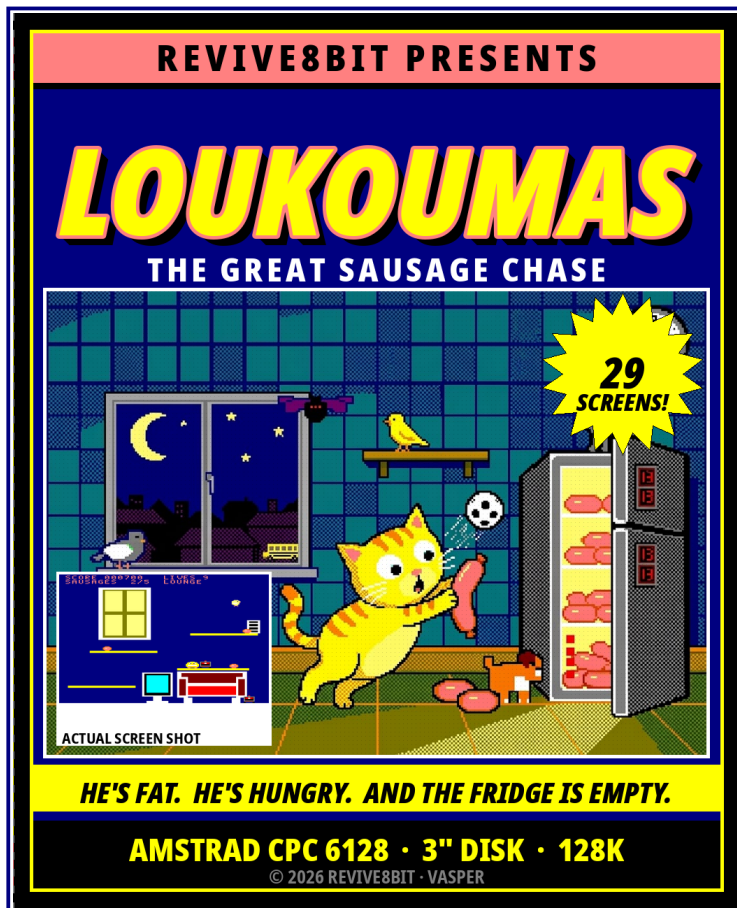


LOUKOUMAS

THE GREAT SAUSAGE CHASE

AMSTRAD CPC 6128 · 3" DISK · 128K

A REVIVE8BIT production · © 2026



The disc inlay — the front of it.

Ελληνικά: [MANUAL.el.md](#) · Booklet: [English PDF](#), [Greek PDF](#)

LOADING

1. Switch on your CPC 6128 and wait for the **Ready** prompt.
2. Put the disc in drive A, label side up.
3. Type

`RUN"LOUK`

and press **ENTER**.

4. The REVIVE8BIT screen appears while the game loads. Press **SPACE** when you are ready, or simply wait ten seconds and it will start by itself.
5. After a second and a half of quiet the title screen paints itself onto the full overscan display, and the music starts.

Do not press **ESC** or reset while the drive light is on.

A 464 or a 664 will not load it. The game wants 128K: it uses one whole half of the machine as a screen.



The title screen. FIRE goes on, L switches to Greek.

THE STORY SO FAR

It is a quarter past three in the morning in Mrs Evdokia's flat in Kypseli. Everybody is asleep. Everybody except one.

Loukoumas — a plump, overweight European Shorthair with short legs, enormous eyes and an unappeasable love of cured meats — has been woken by a rumble in his own stomach. Mrs Evdokia has put him on a diet, and the house is no longer his: a robot vacuum patrols the floors all night, and her canary, the **Tweety-Boxer**, has the run of every room.

Loukoumas starts in the basement with one intention: to climb all the way up to the kitchen and open the big two-door Pitsos.

And he finds it empty.

The last one, the big one, went to school in the lunchbox of **Myrto**, Mrs Evdokia's granddaughter. Outside, the school bus is starting its engine.

From there it stops being a raid and becomes a chase, and it lasts another nineteen rooms: out through the back yard, across the neighbourhood, through the whole school, into the vet's — and home over the rooftops and down the chimney into his own fireplace, where Myrto has left him a bowl of milk.



Act two: out of the flat and into the back yard, in daylight.



Act three: home over the rooftops, and down the chimney.

Twenty-nine rooms. Nine lives — or three, if you ask for them. One sausage.

THE CONTROLS

Keyboard or joystick — either, at any time.

Keyboard	Joystick	What it does
← →	left / right	Walk
↑ or SPACE	up or fire	Jump
↓	down	Roll — curl into a ball
↓ + SPACE in mid-air	down + fire	BELLY-FLOP
L (title screen only)	—	Switch between Greek and English
SPACE (title screen)	fire	Start
ESC	—	Abandon the game and go back to the title

Rolling is faster than walking *and* shorter than standing. There are gaps in this game that a standing cat does not fit through. There is no dignity in it. There is no dignity in any of this.

★ THE BELLY-FLOP ★

Jump, then hold ↓ and hit **SPACE** while you are still in the air. Loukoumas tucks in, drops like a sack of flour and lands flat on his stomach. **The whole room shakes** — and everything at roughly the height he landed at is stunned where it stands, however far along the shelf it happens to be.

This is not a trick. It is the answer to a robot that patrols a whole shelf and will not let you near the sausage on the end of it. Flop, then walk straight through it while it sees stars.

How to do it

- You have to be **in the air** — on the way up, at the top, or falling. Walking off the edge of a shelf counts as much as a jump does. On the ground, ↓ is a roll and nothing else.

- Hold ↓ first, then **press SPACE** (or fire). Holding fire down from the jump does nothing: it has to be a fresh press while ↓ is held. ↑ will not do it — only **SPACE** or fire.
- Once he has tucked in there is no taking it back. He drops at full speed, straight down, and still drifts left and right if you steer.

Where it reaches

- The stun goes off **on landing**, not when you press the button. Flop in mid-air over a robot and it is the shelf you come down on that counts.
- It reaches **sideways across the whole room**. Distance along the shelf does not matter at all.
- It reaches **up and down by about one shelf**: the shelf you landed on, the one just above it and the one just below. Anything two shelves away keeps coming.
- Things in the air are caught too, if they are inside that band at the moment you land. A canary on its way through stops dead in mid-flight.

What it does, and for how long

- A stunned enemy **stops where it is and cannot hurt you**. Walk through it, stand on its shelf, take the sausage behind it.
- It stays down for **two, three or four seconds**, depending on the difficulty (see *HOW HARD DO YOU WANT IT*). There is no warning when it gets up — it simply starts moving again, and from that moment it is dangerous.
- Flop again and the clock starts again, at full length, for everything in reach.
- **Loukoumas pays for it too**: for about a quarter of a second after landing he lies flat and does not answer the controls. Anything awake and out of reach — a bird two shelves up, say — can still catch him there.

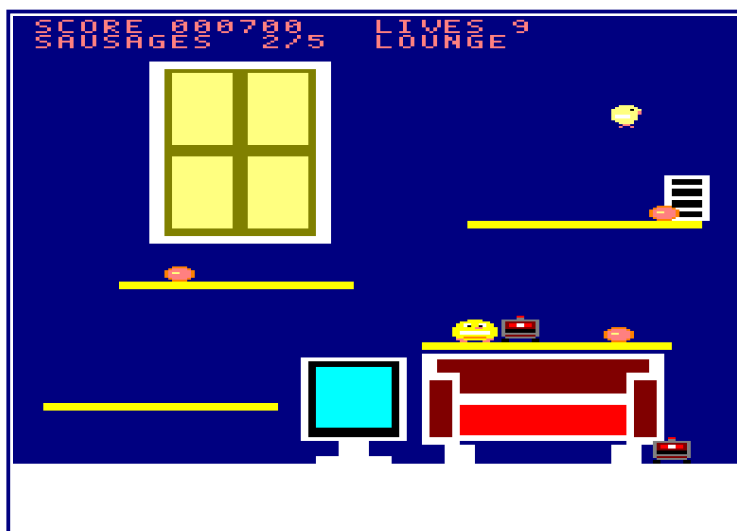
A stunned enemy is harmless scenery — but only until it gets back up.

YOUR SCREEN

Two rows across the top, and they are the only part of the screen that is not the game:

SCORE	001700	LIVES	9
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SCORE	Six digits. It does not reset between rooms
LIVES	Nine, six or three, depending on the difficulty you chose. That number is also the most you can hold
SAUSAGES	How many of this room's five you have found
Room name	Where you are. All twenty-nine have one



The lounge: the HUD on top, five sausages, and a robot patrolling the shelf.

The **border of the screen flashes** when something good happens. It is the only thing on a screen this size that you cannot miss while you are being chased.

WHAT YOU ARE AFTER

SAUSAGES — five in every room, 100 points each. Take all five and the way out of the room — a door, a vent, a fridge, a chimney — **changes** and becomes a way through. Until then it is furniture. You do not have to find them in any order, and nothing comes back if

you lose a life, so a room only ever gets easier.

THE SAUCER OF MILK — every third room. Rooms 3, 6, 9, 12, 15, 18, 21, 24 and 27 have one, and it is **a life back** — but never more than the number you started the game on. If you have not lost one yet it is worth 500 points instead, so it is never wasted; it is worth a great deal more once you have started losing them, and on hard, where you only ever had three, it is worth more still.



The Pitsos in the kitchen, open at last — and empty.

It is always on the most awkward shelf in the room, and usually on the one something is patrolling. The way out does not wait for it: you can finish the room and leave it behind. Whether that is the right call is between you and your remaining lives.

WHAT IS AFTER YOU

Three in every room. Touching any of them costs a life and puts you back at the start of the room with **two seconds of grace** to get out of the way.

Everything in this game either walks a shelf or flies an arc across the room. Learn the two and you have learned all twelve:

	Walks	Flies	Where
Robot vacuum	●		the flat
The canary		●	the flat
Next door's terrier	●		back yard, pavement, the vet's
Pigeon		●	park, street, rooftops
Wasp		●	anywhere with flowers
Football	●		playground, gym, pitch
Paper plane		●	the school
The caretaker's bucket	●		the school
Something green	●		the chemistry lab
Syringe		●	the vet's
Bat		●	rooftops, chimney
The stray tom	●		rooftops, car park

Nothing shoots at you. Nothing follows you. They do not have to — the rooms are small and you are not fast.

HOW HARD DO YOU WANT IT

After the title screen, and before the first room, the game asks. Use ← and → to change it and **SPACE** to accept.



It borrows the title screen's footer: the question, the answer, and the keys.

	Lives	Enemies	The belly-flop stun lasts
EASY	9	Half speed	Four seconds
MEDIUM	6	Two thirds	Three seconds
HARD	3	Full speed	Two seconds

HARD is the game as it was designed — three lives, and everything moving at the speed it was drawn to move at. Easy and medium do not make Loukoumas faster or the rooms kinder: they give you more lives and longer to think. The jump is the same jump, the shelves are the same distance apart, and every sausage is in the same place.

SCORING

Sausage	100
Saucer of milk	a life back — or 500 if you have not lost one yet

There is no time bonus and no end-of-room bonus. The score is what you picked up.

WHEN IT ENDS

Lose your last life and the room stops where it stands with **GAME OVER** across it. Press **SPACE** (or fire) to start again from the first room at the same difficulty, or **ESC** to go back to the title screen — and to the language and difficulty menus with it.



Out of lives. FIRE starts a new game, ESC goes back to the title.

Get through all twenty-nine and you get **WELL DONE!**, which in 1986 was considered generous.

HINTS FROM THE PLAYTESTERS

- **Look before you jump.** The jump clears about forty scanlines and the shelves are thirty-two apart, so every shelf is reachable from the one below it — but only from the one below it.
- **Platforms are one-way.** You land on a shelf falling, and you pass straight up through it rising. That is a route, not a bug: go up through the thing you cannot walk

around.

- **The flop is a key, not a weapon.** Nothing in this game dies. A shelf you cannot cross is a shelf you have not flopped on yet.
- **Take the milk when you are down a life or two.** Untouched it is only points; one short, it is the way back up. It is on the hardest shelf in the room either way, and you will not want to go back for it on your last one.
- **Learn where the canary turns.** Everything that flies bounces between the same two walls for ever. Stand where it has just been.
- **Rolling under something is usually faster than jumping over it,** and it is always safer than landing on it.
- **Escape is not a pause.** There is no pause. It was 1986.

FOR THE TECHNICALLY MINDED

The whole screen is picture: 96 bytes by 272 scanlines — **26,112 bytes**, or half the machine — and there is no border anywhere. The CRTC is programmed to fetch across two 16K pages on a character-row boundary, which is what buys a 32K display with no mid-frame reprogramming at all, so it looks the same on every CRTC type Amstrad ever shipped.

There is no double buffer; there is no room for one. Every sprite keeps the patch of background it covers and hands it back before it moves. The picture is rebuilt twenty-five times a second and the game thinks fifty times a second, so the jump arc is exactly what it always was.

Both languages are in the same binary, and **L** repaints the text rather than the screen.

The full story is in loukoumas.en.md; how the machine is driven is in CLAUDE.md.

CREDITS

Code, graphics and design

VASPER

Music

Arkos Tracker 3 (AKG player by Targhan / Arkos)

Loukoumas is a cat. No sausages were harmed in the making of this game. The same cannot be said for the diet.